

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1253

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to recognize Lily D. Barnes on the occasion of her retirement as Register of Deeds for Hardeman County.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should honor those citizens who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their careers in public service; and

WHEREAS, Lily D. Barnes, Register of Deeds for Hardeman County, is one such estimable individual, who has distinguished herself as a professional of the greatest dedication, ability, and integrity; and

WHEREAS, after twenty-eight years as Hardeman County Register of Deeds, Mrs. Barnes is taking her much-deserved retirement from that office at the end of her current term; and

WHEREAS, born on March 10, 1961, Lily D. Barnes is the daughter of Guy and Bobbie Jean Dorris and was taught the importance of hard work and honesty at an early age alongside her siblings, Guy, Scarlett, Amber, and David; and

WHEREAS, a 1979 graduate of Bolivar Central High School, Lily Barnes began her public service career with Hardeman County in 1987 as an employee of the Hardeman County Clerk's Office before taking two years off to stay home with her children; she returned to work in the Hardeman County Trustees office for two years; and

WHEREAS, first elected to the post of Register of Deeds in August 1998 and unopposed for six consecutive terms, Lily Barnes has provided steady and faithful leadership in maintaining the public records of Hardeman County through a period of significant technological transition and growth; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Barnes's commitment to professional excellence is reflected in her extensive involvement in statewide and regional organizations, having served tenures as

president of the Tennessee Register Association and the County Officials Association of Tennessee and as a member of committees of both organizations, including the Legislative, Audit, Membership, and Awards committees; and

WHEREAS, a Certified Public Administrator, Lily Barnes completed the Local Government Leadership Program in 2015 and was honored as the Outstanding Register of the Year in 2001 and 2018 and named the Register of the Year in 2007; and

WHEREAS, an active part of her community, she is a longtime member of the Bolivar Rotary Club, which she has served as president and treasurer, and is a faithful congregant of Hornsby Baptist Church, where she teaches pre-school for Project 4:13; and

WHEREAS, a devoted wife, mother, and grandmother, Lily Barnes enjoys the love and support of her husband, Greg Barnes; their children, Ginia (Ben), Clint, and Katiellen (Josh); and their grandchildren, Ryder, Ridge, Brooks, and Landry; and

WHEREAS, throughout her distinguished career, Mrs. Barnes has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, winning the unqualified respect and admiration of her colleagues and the citizens she has so ably served; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Lily D. Barnes upon her retirement as Hardeman County Register of Deeds, thank her for her many years of dedicated service, and extend to her our heartfelt wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement and every continued success in her future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.